



SURVEY REPORT

UNLOCKING ESG EXCELLENCE

2024 -2025





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ABOUT THE COMPANY

Aumyaa Consulting Services LLP is a women lead and managed tech enabled consulting firm to provide high-impact solutions to global businesses. We provide services in the area of Sustainability and ESG Consulting, Business Consulting, Risk Consulting, and Technology Consulting. Aumyaa provides services to listed and unlisted companies across almost all the industry sectors. ESG consulting services include developing Sustainability/ESG strategy with specific goals, ESG Materiality and Risk Assessment, Supply Chain Assessment, Net Zero Transition, Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting, and Assurance.

Our leaders are self-made and have experience of BIG 4 and Fortune 500 companies and have served clients across the globe. They have served a diverse range of clients, spanning multinationals, listed companies, privately owned companies, and family-owned businesses in the domain of ESG, Risk and Technology Consulting. Aumyaa believes in taking guidance and learning from nature for delivering creative, innovative simple cost-effective solutions. Our guiding principle is to develop long lasting relationships with our stakeholders based on our integrity, trust and quality deliverables. We continuously learn to improve daily and remain calm and balanced through collective value creation.

CEO's Message

As we present this Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) report, we are proud to share the commitments we uphold at Aumyaa and the strategy to achieve them. Our dedication to sustainability and social responsibility is not just a compliance requirement, it is a core component of our business strategy and culture. We have consistently recognized our ESG responsibilities as essential to our goal of creating a positive impact on the society and environment. We are dedicated to conducting business in an environmentally and socially responsible manner, aiming to safeguard the environment, preserve resources, and promote sustainable development. Our services to our clients have potential to drive efficiencies through optimized usage of resources. As we look ahead, we remain focused on enhancing our ESG initiatives. We will continue to engage with our stakeholders and clients to understand their concerns and expectations, ensuring that our environmental, social, and governance strategies align with their values. Together, we can build a resilient and responsible business that contributes positively to society while delivering value to our stakeholders.



YUKTI ARORA
CEO
AUMYAA CONSULTING
SERVICES LLP



Partner's ESG Message

At Aumyaa we strongly believe that sustainability is not a buzzword but an opportunity for organizations to drive innovation, growth and positive impact. This ESG Report outlines our environmental performance on a number of parameters and have established baselines for the future and set targets to improve our environmental performance. Resonating with our ethos, we have already adopted technology to enable hybrid model and paperless office thereby significantly reducing our environmental footprint. We promote good governance through established policies and procedures for promoting transparency and accountability. We invest in employee well-being, diversity, and inclusion initiatives, and also foster positive relationships with customers based on trust and transparency.



Our Panelists



Yukti Arora

CEO of Aumyaa Consulting Services, and qualified CA, CISA, DISA, and ISO 27001 lead auditor.



Jyoti Singh

Partner at Aumyaa Consulting Services, and qualified CA with DISA certification, Certificate Course on BRSR (ICAI).



Priya Ranjan

Sustainability advisor at Aumyaa Consulting services. An expert in Sustainability Strategy and Disclosures (IFRS, GRI, TCFD, CDP, CII Greenco) and a certified Wellness Coach committed to mental health.



Industry Standards for BRSR Core Reporting

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), in collaboration with the Industry Standards Forum (ISF), has introduced standardized practices for Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report (BRSR) Core disclosures in its circular – “SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-PoD-1/P/CIR/2024/177” dated 20th December 2024. These standards, effective from FY 2024-25, aim to streamline reporting under Regulation 34(2)(f) of the SEBI LODR, 2015. The ISF, comprising representatives from ASSOCHAM, CII, and FICCI, developed these guidelines in consultation with SEBI to enhance transparency and ease of compliance for listed entities. The standards are hosted on the websites of SEBI, stock exchanges, and participating industry associations.

BRSR Core Reporting Framework

The BRSR Core standards provide a robust framework for environmental, social, and governance (ESG) disclosures. The structure is divided into two parts. Part A focuses on general requirements, such as intensity-based calculations for greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, water consumption, energy usage, and waste management. Metrics are calculated using revenue adjusted for purchasing power parity (PPP) and output-based intensity. Part B addresses attribute-specific requirements, including detailed metrics for GHG emissions, water and energy footprints, circular waste management, employee wellbeing, gender diversity, and inclusive development.

Provisional Carbon Accounting Proxy Methodology

Recognizing data challenges faced by enterprises, SEBI has introduced a provisional Carbon Accounting Proxy (CAP) methodology for estimating Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions. This spend-based approach leverages financial data to estimate emissions in cases where direct measurement data is unavailable. The CAP methodology involves converting financial expenditure on fuels and electricity into quantity-based estimates, which are then used to calculate emissions using recognized emission factors. While useful for early compliance, this approach is intended for short-term use, with enterprises encouraged to transition to quantity-based methods for greater accuracy.

Key Metrics and Disclosure Requirements

The standards mandate the reporting of critical sustainability metrics. These include GHG emissions, water and energy consumption, and waste intensity calculated against revenue or production outputs. For employee wellbeing, entities must disclose expenditures on health and safety measures, maternity/paternity benefits, and mental health programs. Gender diversity metrics include the proportion of wages paid to female employees and complaints filed under the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Act. Companies are also required to report on customer and supplier engagement practices, including data breach incidents and openness in business transactions.

Governance and Sustainability Goals

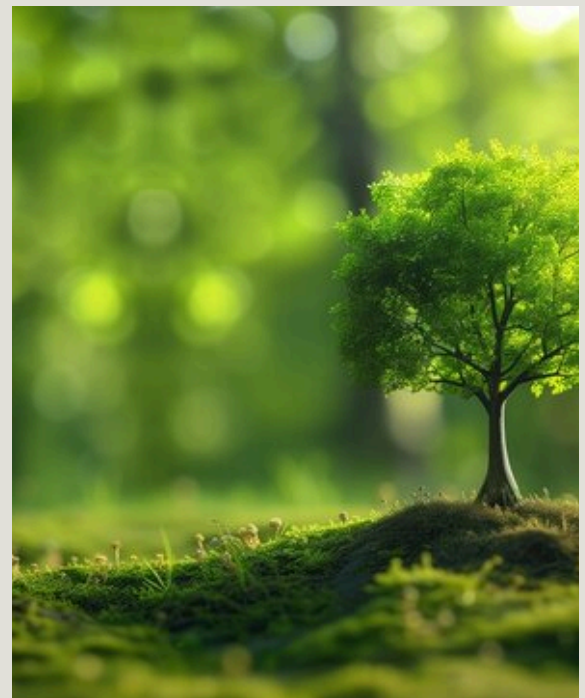
The BRSR Core standards are designed to align listed entities with global ESG practices, fostering accountability and sustainable business operations. By standardizing disclosures and introducing practical methodologies like CAP, SEBI seeks to address implementation challenges while ensuring progress toward long-term sustainability goals. These efforts underscore the commitment to making Indian enterprises globally competitive and environmentally responsible.

Introduction

The Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) landscape in India is undergoing a significant transformation, driven by regulatory advancements and a growing emphasis on sustainable business practices. The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has introduced the Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report (BRSR) framework, mandating the top 1,000 listed companies by market capitalization to disclose their ESG activities in a standardized format. The BRSR, divided into General Disclosures, Management Disclosures, and Principle-wise Performance, aligns with the National Guidelines on Responsible Business Conduct (NGRBC) and enhances transparency and stakeholder assessment of non-financial performance. To further streamline reporting, SEBI launched 'BRSR Core' in July 2023, featuring key performance indicators tailored to India's context, such as job creation in small towns and wages paid to women. Additionally, SEBI has expanded the sustainable finance framework, proposing green securitization and broadening the scope of instruments like social bonds, sustainable bonds, and sustainability-linked bonds. These initiatives reflect SEBI's commitment to embedding ESG factors into financial decision-making and promoting responsible business conduct. With increasing regulatory requirements and SEBI's proactive approach, companies in India are being encouraged to integrate ESG considerations into their strategies, fostering environmental sustainability, social well-being, and strong governance. These efforts aim to provide stakeholders with comprehensive insights into ESG performance, enabling informed decision-making and long-term value creation in the corporate sector.

Objectives of the survey

The objective of the survey report is to gather insights into the current state of ESG integration within organizations, focusing on key aspects such as the development of an ESG roadmap and materiality assessment, the challenges and best practices in preparing ESG reports under frameworks like Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting (BRSR), and the evolving requirements of BRSR Core. The survey also aims to explore the role and impact of assurance in enhancing the credibility of ESG reports and aligning them with stakeholder expectations. Furthermore, it seeks to understand how organizations are building a compelling business case for ESG and long term sustainability, particularly in terms of engaging and securing board-level commitment to ESG strategies. This comprehensive analysis will help identify trends, gaps, and opportunities to drive meaningful progress in ESG implementation and reporting practices.

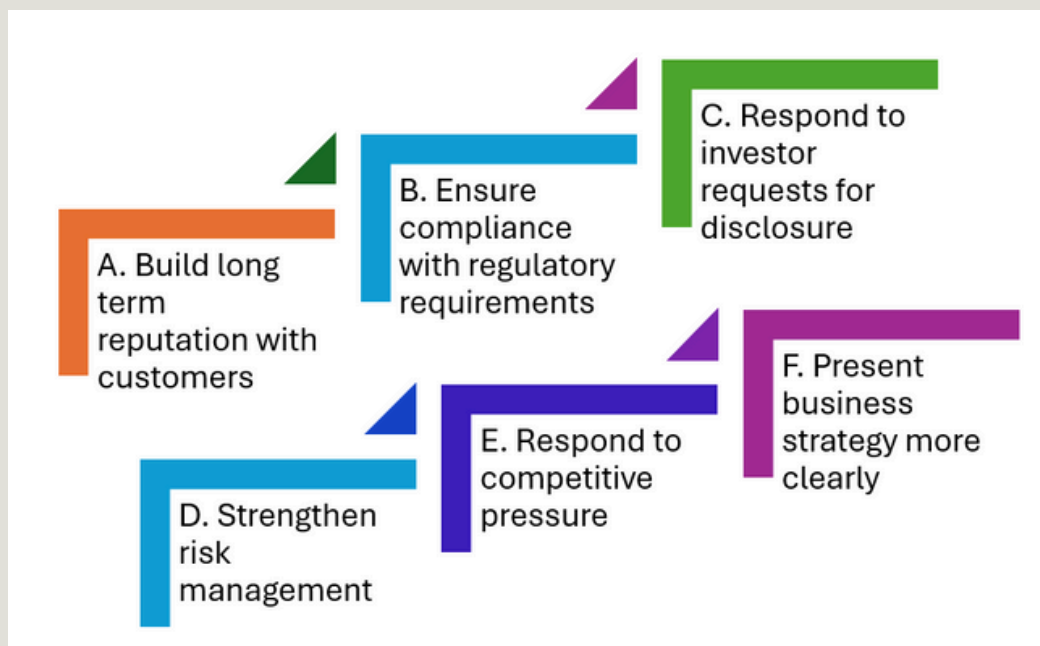


METHODOLOGY OF THE SURVEY

This Survey was conducted through discussions and polls during four series of ESG Webinars organized by Aumyaa. There were respondents representing various sectors and who were either from corporates or providing ESG consulting services. By engaging participants from different sectors and backgrounds, the survey aimed to provide a comprehensive understanding of current practices, challenges, and opportunities in the field of ESG reporting and assurance.

KEY DRIVERS FOR ESG DISCLOSURES

Regulatory compliance, building customer trust, and presenting clear business strategies are key drivers for ESG disclosures. Additionally, risk management plays a significant role, while investor demands and competitive pressure are less influential. Our respondents believed that regulatory compliance is the most significant driver for organizations to make ESG disclosures, closely followed by the need to build long-term customer trust and clearly present business strategies. Strengthening risk management also plays an important role, while factors such as responding to investor requests and competitive pressure are less influential in driving ESG disclosure efforts.

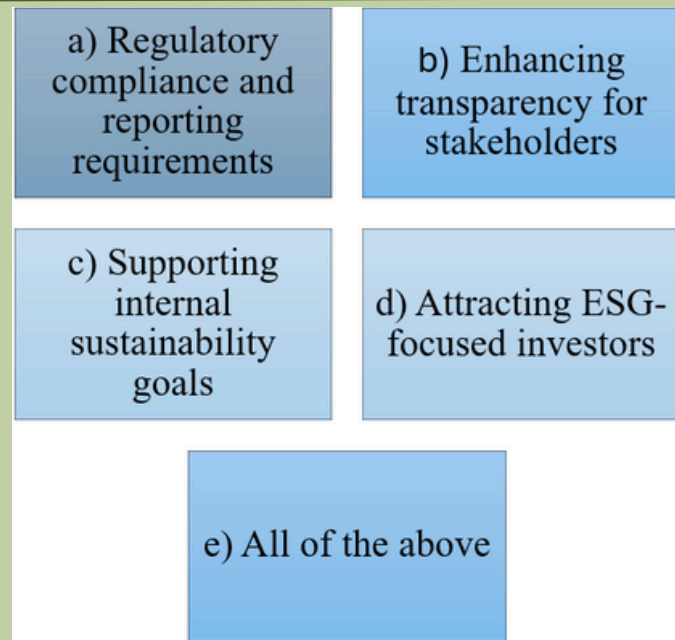


The analysis reveals that regulatory compliance is the strongest motivator (100%) for organizations to make ESG disclosures, followed by building long-term customer reputation (87%) and presenting business strategy more clearly (67%). Factors like risk management (58%) also hold significant influence, while responding to investor requests (22%) and competitive pressure (0%) are less critical drivers. This suggests that while some companies may be hesitant to voluntarily disclose ESG data, regulatory mandates can serve as a powerful catalyst for increased transparency. This highlights the importance of clear guidelines and consistent enforcement to encourage broader adoption of ESG reporting practices.



Primary Driver for Improving ESG Data Management

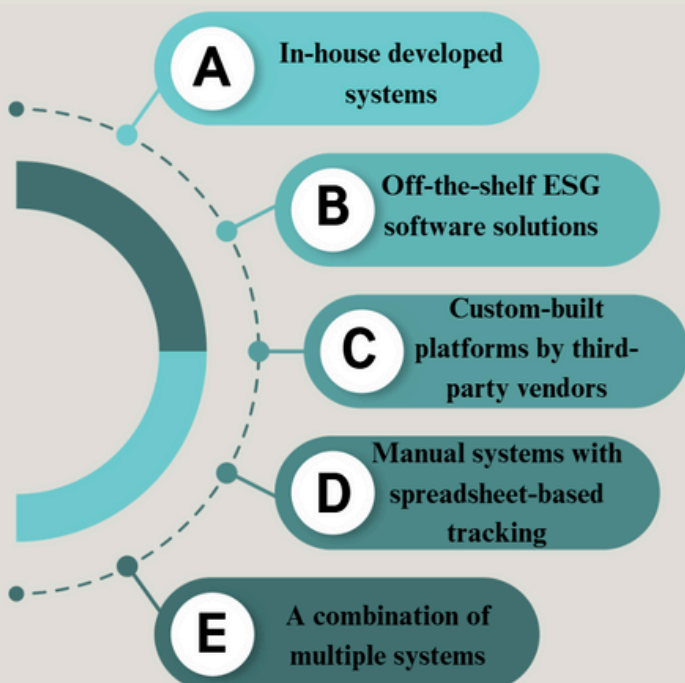
The primary driver for improving ESG data management is a holistic approach that integrates regulatory compliance, transparency, sustainability goals, and investor expectations, thereby showcasing a multi – faceted approach. This comprehensive focus ensures alignment with organizational and stakeholder priorities. Supporting internal sustainability goals also plays a significant role, while regulatory compliance, transparency, and attracting ESG-focused investors are less influential motivators in this context.



The analysis indicates that the primary driver for improving ESG data management is a broad, encompassing approach, with 60% of respondents selecting "All of the above." Supporting internal sustainability goals is also a notable motivator (20%), while regulatory compliance, transparency, and attracting ESG-focused investors are not significant drivers in this case (0%).

Type of ESG Data Management System Used

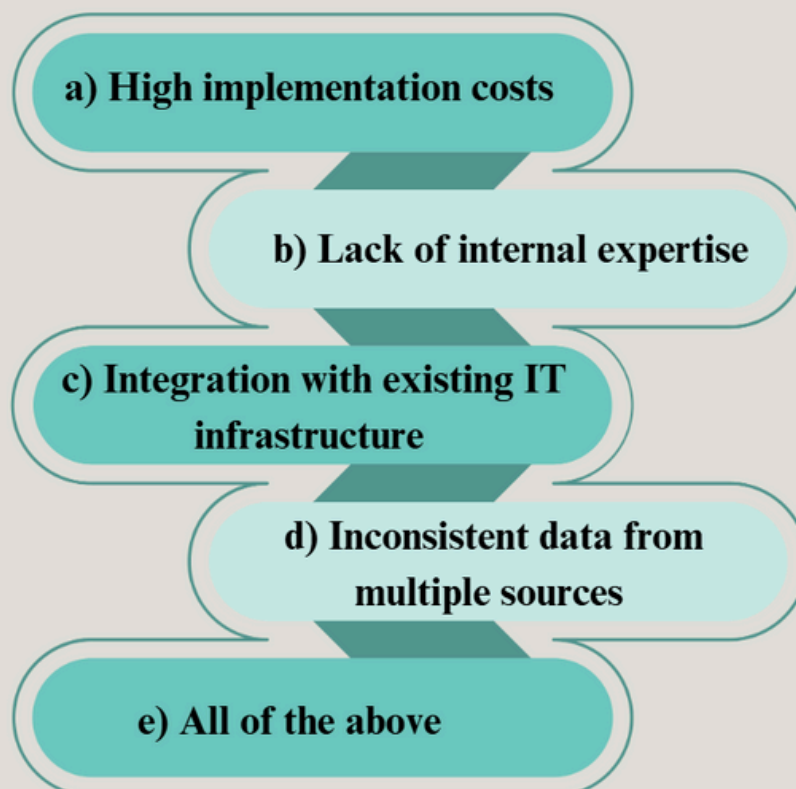
The analysis shows that most organizations (80%) use a combination of multiple systems for ESG data management. Custom-built platforms by third-party vendors (40%) and manual systems with spreadsheet-based tracking (40%) are also commonly used, while off-the-shelf ESG software solutions are less prevalent (20%). No organizations rely solely on in-house developed systems (0%).



Our analysis indicates that Organizations commonly rely on a combination of systems for ESG data management, including custom-built platforms and manual spreadsheet tracking. use of Off-the-shelf ESG software is less prevalent, with in-house developed systems rarely used. Custom-built platforms from third-party vendors and manual spreadsheet tracking are also widely adopted. Sole reliance on in-house developed systems is virtually nonexistent in most cases.

Challenges in Implementing ESG Data Management

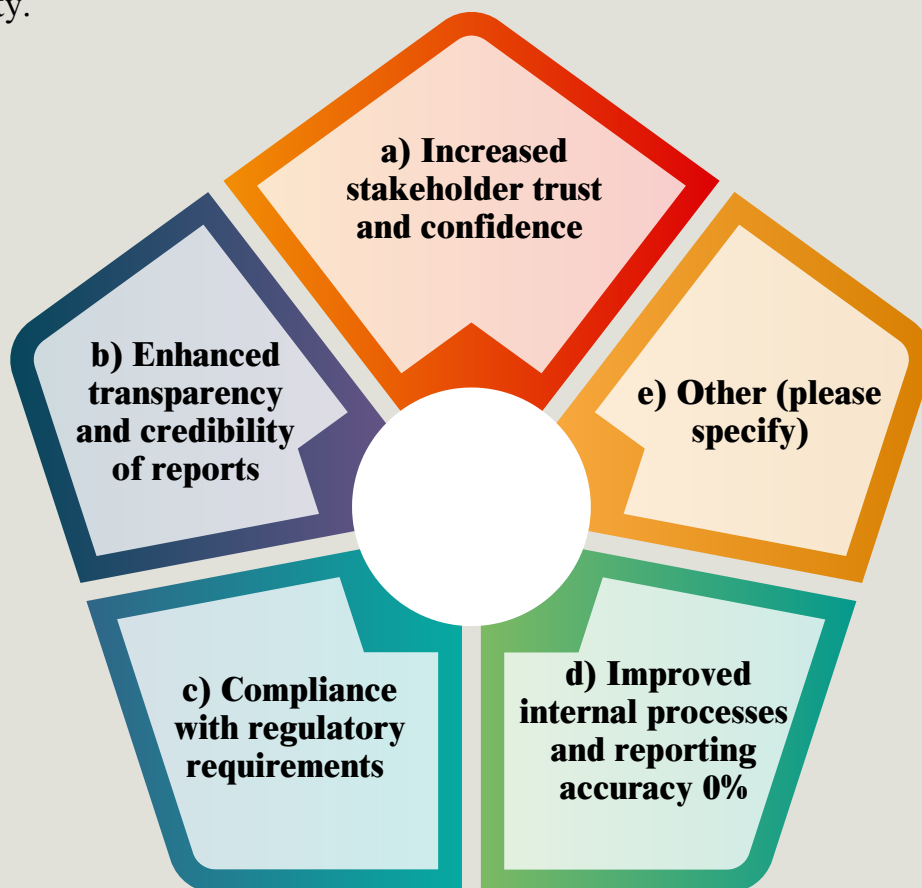
The main challenges in implementing ESG data management include a lack of internal expertise and the complexities of integrating various systems. Our analysis reveals that organizations face a range of challenges when implementing a robust ESG data management system, with the lack of internal expertise being a notable obstacle. While high implementation integration with existing infrastructure, and inconsistent data from multiple sources are not major concerns, a combination of other factors contributes to the overall difficulty.



The analysis indicates that 80% of organizations face challenges in implementing a robust ESG data management system due to a combination of factors. A lack of internal expertise is a challenge for 20% of organizations, while issues like high implementation costs, integration with existing infrastructure, and inconsistent data from multiple sources do not appear to be significant concerns (0%). To bridge the gap in internal expertise, organizations should prioritize investing in training and development programs to equip their employees with the necessary knowledge and skills. Furthermore, leveraging technology can significantly streamline data collection, analysis, and reporting processes, making ESG reporting more efficient and effective.

Enhancing BRSR Disclosures with External Assurance

The foremost benefit recognized is the enhancement of transparency and credibility in organizational reporting, positioning it as a key driver for trust and reliability in disclosures. This is closely followed by the role of external assurance in ensuring compliance with evolving regulatory requirements, reinforcing its importance in maintaining adherence to standards. Other potential advantages, such as fostering greater stakeholder trust, streamlining internal processes, and addressing additional specified factors, were not given significant emphasis. This analysis highlights the pivotal role of external assurance in not only improving the quality and integrity of reports but also in supporting regulatory alignment and overall accountability.

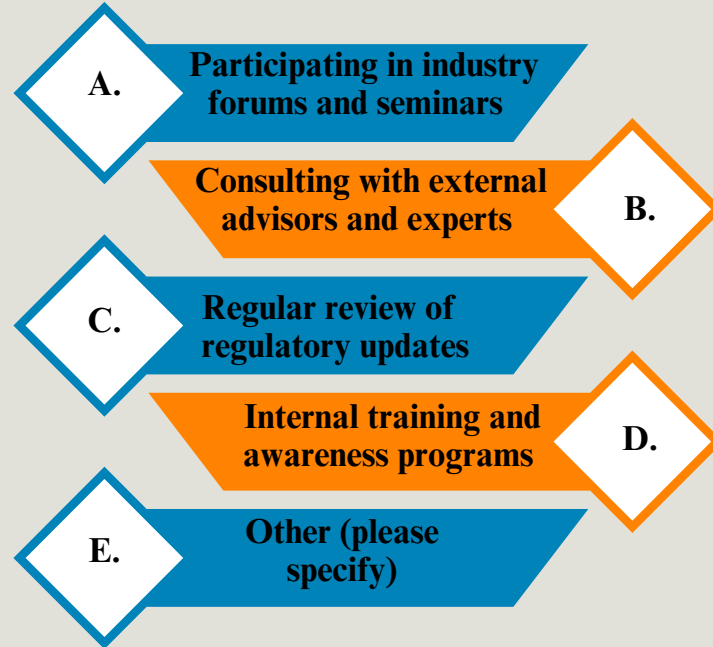


A key advantage of external assurance is that it significantly boosts the transparency and credibility of ESG reports (67%), while also ensuring compliance with relevant regulations (33%). By providing independent verification, it fosters greater trust and confidence among stakeholders in a company's ESG performance. Other benefits, such as increased stakeholder trust, improved internal processes, and other specified factors, were not selected (0%). This highlights the emphasis on external assurance as a tool for building report credibility and meeting stakeholder expectations and regulatory standards.

Adapting to Evolving BRSR Regulations and Standards

Organizations primarily rely on external sources to stay informed about evolving BRSR regulations. The most common methods include participating in industry forums and seminars, consulting with external advisors and experts, and regularly reviewing regulatory updates from authorities, with each approach being equally important. Internal efforts such as training and awareness programs were not utilized, indicating a preference for external channels to remain current with regulatory changes.

The analysis indicates that organizations majority y rely on external methods to stay updated with evolving BRSR regulations. A third of organizations participate in industry forums and seminars, while another third consult with external advisors and experts. Additionally, a third of organizations regularly review regulatory updates from authorities. While internal training and awareness programs could play a crucial role in fostering a deeper understanding of BRSR requirements among employees, they are currently underutilized as information sources. By investing in internal training, organizations can empower their employees to better integrate ESG principles into their daily work and drive more sustainable business practices.



How Do ESG Factors Influence Board Decisions in Indian Corporates?

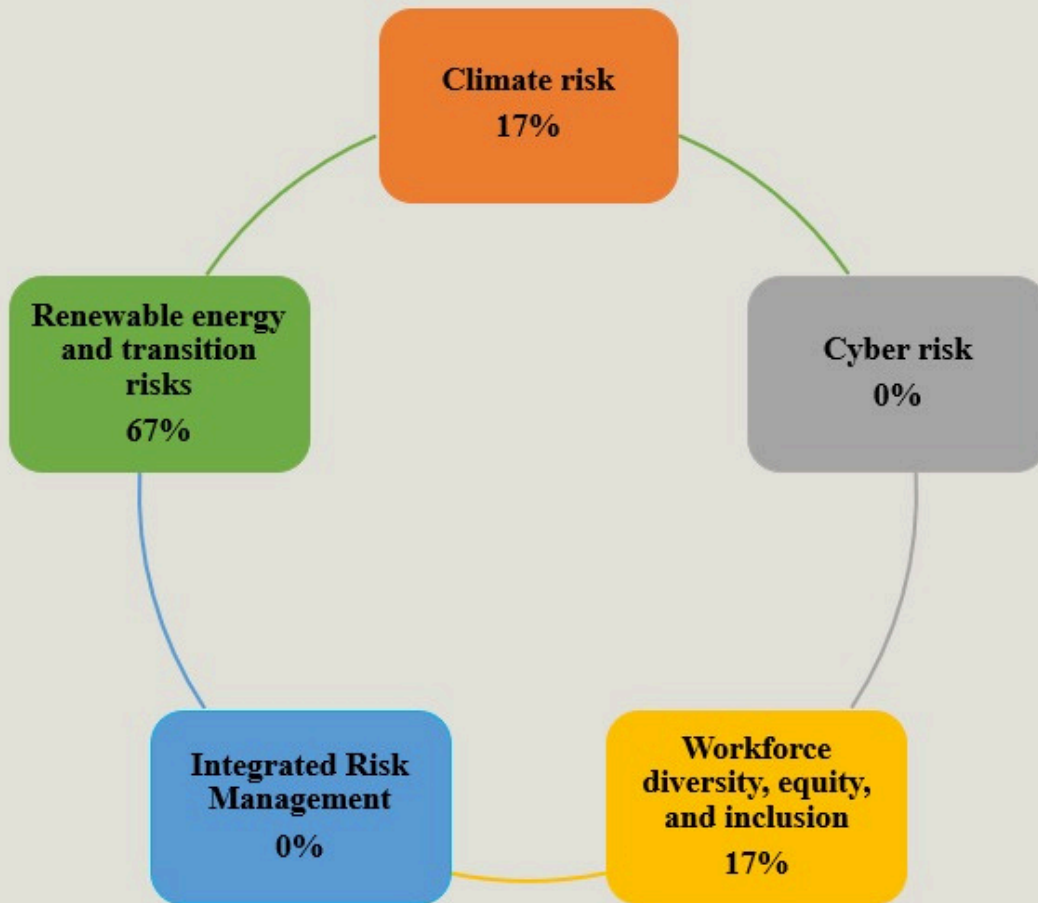
ESG factors play a significant role in shaping board decisions in Indian corporates, with most boards integrating them into strategic decision-making, emphasizing their growing importance. Some boards delegate ESG considerations to specialized committees, signaling a structured approach. Notably, ESG is no longer seen as just a legal compliance matter, reflecting a broader commitment to sustainability.



A majority (83%) of respondents believe Indian corporate boards integrate ESG factors into strategic decision-making, highlighting their growing importance and awareness. A smaller segment (17%) indicates ESG is managed by separate committees. This suggests a focused approach but potentially less seamless integration with overall business strategy. Notably, no respondents view ESG as merely a legal formality, reflecting a strategic shift toward sustainability and responsible governance.

KEY ESG AREAS FOR BOARD TRAINING

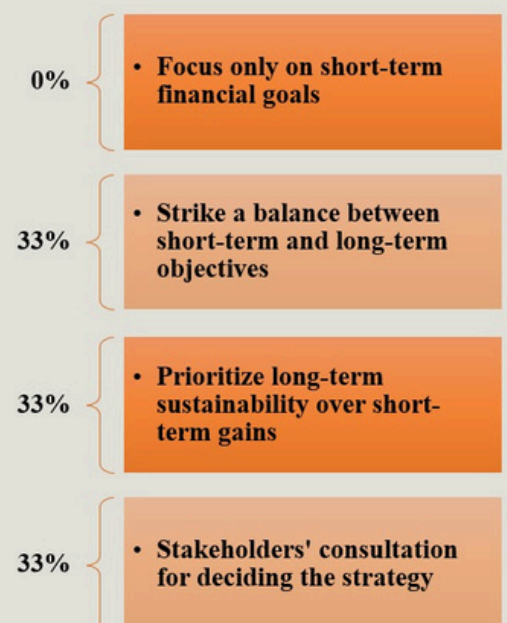
Boards prioritize awareness in renewable energy and transition risks, highlighting its critical relevance. Equal focus is placed on climate risk and workforce diversity, equity, and inclusion, while cyber risk and integrated risk management receive minimal attention, indicating potential gaps in training emphasis.



Key ESG areas for board training include understanding climate risk, renewable energy transition challenges, and workforce diversity, equity, and inclusion. Equipping boards with knowledge in these areas helps ensure informed decision-making that aligns with sustainability goals and enhances long-term value creation.

BALANCING FINANCIAL GOALS AND SUSTAINABILITY IN ESG

Indian boards are divided on how to balance short-term financial goals with long-term sustainability. One-third advocates for prioritizing long-term sustainability over short-term gains, while another third emphasizes striking a balance between both. The remaining third suggests involving stakeholders in the strategy formulation, underscoring the importance of a collaborative approach to ESG decision-making. This indicates that professionals give equal importance to all aspects while strategizing their sustainability initiatives.



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